

Chapter 120-4

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Not far from the Minghui Jewelry building, Sally and Lin Luoxi were bickering with each other, while Xu Qingzhu stood to the side like a glowing light bulb.¹

She didn't feel uncomfortable though.

After all, since university, she had often been the third wheel for these two.

On the surface, the two were going back and forth at each other, but secretly they were sweet as honey.

A couple who had just gotten back together—their honeymoon phase was even longer than when they first started dating, and even more passionate and intense.

Today Sally felt cooped up, so they came down early.

It was only a few minutes earlier than the regular employees, and Sally said she wanted to go eat at that hard-to-reserve army stew restaurant.²

When they came down, Xu Qingzhu was still reading a document on her phone. She was just reaching the end of the document when she almost bumped into someone while walking—Lin Luoxi pulled her back just in time.

She hurriedly finished reading the document before exiting the work app.

She had just exited and hadn't had time to put down her phone when Lin Luoxi patted her arm. "Hey, isn't that Liang Shi?"

Xu Qingzhu stopped walking and looked up to scan around, but couldn't find the right direction. Lin Luoxi had to forcibly turn her head. "Over there."

Only then did Xu Qingzhu see her.

Liang Shi was wearing a camel-colored coat, her long curly hair draped lazily over her shoulders, holding a bouquet of purple baby's breath in her arms. Someone happened to be chatting her up.

An awkward smile appeared on that gentle face, but she still waved the person off.

Sally said from the side: "Who would've thought? Liang Shi is quite popular."

Lin Luoxi scoffed lightly. "Our Zhuzi isn't bad either, okay?"

Sally immediately said: "I didn't say Blanche was bad."

Lin Luoxi was quite annoyed by her particular fondness for Liang Shi. Dissatisfied with her answer, she jabbed her with her elbow.

Sally, with her blonde hair and blue eyes, should clearly have been a cool and aloof beauty, but in front of Lin Luoxi, she became a pitiful little fool, asking aggrievedly: "Why are you mad again?"

Lin Luoxi rolled her eyes at her. "I'm annoyed looking at you."

Sally: "..."

Xu Qingzhu wasn't listening to their conversation. Her phone vibrated slightly—it was a message from Liang Shi.

If it were just two simple sentences appearing on the screen, those two sentences would have made Xu Qingzhu feel pleasantly surprised.

But paired with that lonely figure, those forlorn eyes.

Something in Xu Qingzhu's heart was touched.

Sally suggested: "Call Liang Shi over, let's eat together."

But Xu Qingzhu put away her phone and walked toward Liang Shi without looking back. "You two go eat."

Sally: "?"

A few seconds later, Sally said dazedly: "Blanche just stood us up?"

"What else?" Lin Luoxi answered expressionlessly. "She's someone nourished by love now."

Sally: "..."

Lin Luoxi didn't even look at her and walked off on her own.

It took Sally a moment to react before she jogged after her. "Wait..."

Meanwhile, Liang Shi had been waiting for Xu Qingzhu to reply and hadn't looked up.

Only when she sensed a focused gaze directed at her did she slowly raise her head, and then her eyes met Xu Qingzhu's.

Xu Qingzhu looked at her, her eyes slowly curving.

A smile visibly spread across her face.

Liang Shi stood there and smiled along with her.

Without doing anything, just standing there, she was like a painting—different from all the noisy backgrounds of this world.

Or rather, all those people coming and going were just the backdrop.

Liang Shi could only see her.

Meeting again after several days, neither of them spoke.

It was Liang Shi who stepped forward first, handing her the flowers in her arms.

"Is today a special day?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi thought for a moment and shook her head. "Nothing special."

The conversation started from there.

No awkwardness, no unfamiliarity from days apart—just like when they used to spend every day together.

A strand of Xu Qingzhu's hair was blown astray by the wind. Liang Shi reached out to tuck it behind her ear, her hand landing on her cheek, her fingertip brushing against the edge of her ear as she said gently: "Xu Qingzhu, have you not been eating properly?"

"That's your imagination." Xu Qingzhu lowered her head and took out the greeting card, seeing the blessing written on it.

She asked perceptively: "Did you go see Chen Mian?"

Liang Shi: "..."

The comfort of being with Xu Qingzhu was that even if you said nothing, she understood you.

She just didn't know if it was because Xu Qingzhu was smart, or because she was willing to think about things related to her.

She didn't know if Xu Qingzhu was like this only with her, or with everyone.

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1. Light bulb (电灯泡): Chinese slang for a third wheel—someone who tags along with a couple and "illuminates" their romantic moments, making them feel watched. ↩
 2. Army stew (部队锅): Also known as "budae-jjigae," a Korean fusion stew that originated after the Korean War, made with ingredients like spam, sausages, ramen noodles, and vegetables in a spicy broth. ↩